# Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held Electronically on Monday, April 19, 2021 at 7:00 p.m.

***Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:***
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

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| Present: | Mayor | S. Collier |
| | Regional Councillors | M. Crawford |
| | | S. Lee |
| | | J. Dies |
| | Councillors | R. Tyler Morin |
| | | A. Khan |
| | | L. Bower |

## 1. Call to Order & Land Acknowledgement

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

## 2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

## 3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the following minutes of previous Council meetings be adopted:

- Special Meeting of February 11, 2021; and
- Regular Meeting of March 22, 2021

CARRIED

## 4. Question Period

Mayor Collier noted that members of the public were advised they could submit questions regarding the agenda to the Town Clerk up until noon on the day of the meeting. Alexander Harras, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk, noted that no questions had been received regarding the contents of the meeting agenda.

## 5. Delegations and Presentations

### 5.1 Presentation: 2021 West Division Community Safety Plan

Inspector Mitch Martin and Staff Sergeant Kevin Yamada of Durham Regional Police West Division delivered a presentation regarding the 2021 West Division Community Safety Plan. Inspector Martin discussed improvements to roadway safety, property crime reduction strategies, violent crime reduction strategies, community engagement and innovation in service delivery, enhanced communication, social development, and the Durham Live-Pickering casino.

Council Members asked questions regarding hate crime statistics in Ajax, the number of unreported hate crimes, reduced compliance checks during COVID-19, community outreach priorities, policies to keep the public informed and apprised of community concerns, safety initiatives for senior groups, procedures for complaints about non-compliance with COVID-19 guidelines, remedies to address street racing and loud motor vehicles, the status of the Neighbourhood Watch program, availability of a monthly report related to trends and traffic enforcement, compliance check procedures, and increased graffiti / tagging and its correlation to gang related activity. Inspector Martin responded to

questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked Inspector Martin and Staff Sergeant Yamada for their presentation.

5.2 **Proclamation: Human Values Day – April 24, 2021**

Manish Rughani, Walk for Values, introduced Dr. Revathi Chennabathni, Principal at Sathya Sai School of Toronto. Dr. Chennabathni discussed the objective of the 'Walk for Values', human values awareness, community membership, community partnerships, and Human Values initiatives.

Mayor Collier presented the proclamation certificate and proclaimed April 24, 2021 as Human Values Day in the Town of Ajax.

5.3 **Proclamation: Youth Week 2021**

Ashley McWhirter, Community Recreation Supervisor – Youth Development, explained the purpose of Youth Week in Ajax, highlighting the importance of celebrating local youth. A. McWhirter reviewed the virtual events occurring during Youth Week, including the Quiz Whiz event on May 5, 2021.

Mayor Collier presented the proclamation certificate and proclaimed May 1-7, 2021 as Youth Week in the Town of Ajax.

5.4 **Proclamation: Ontario Volunteer Service Awards Recipients**

Sarah Moore, Committee & Accessibility Coordinator, highlighted the importance of volunteerism to the Town of Ajax and expressed appreciation for the Town's volunteers. S. Moore provided an overview of the Ontario Volunteer Service Awards and recognized the award recipients, noting that collectively they have contributed 50 years of consultation and community engagement through volunteerism with the Town.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked the volunteers for their hard work and contributions.

## 6. Correspondence

Members separated correspondence items 6.5, 6.6, 6.20, and 6.22 for discussion.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the balance of the report (Items 6.1, 6.2, 6.3, 6.4, 6.7, 6.8, 6.9, 6.10, 6.11, 6.12, 6.13, 6.14, 6.15, 6.16, 6.17, 6.18, 6.19 and 6.21) dated April 19, 2021 containing Items of Correspondence be received for information.

CARRIED

Item 6.5

Council Members asked if the Province has provided any updates regarding this matter. Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, and Cameron Richardson, Supervisor of Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change, responded to Members of Council.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That Item 6.5 ("Region of Durham – Resolution re: Lake Simcoe and Lake Ontario UYSS Options") of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item 6.6

Council Members discussed the motion and the impacts and risks associated with flooding.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

That Item 6.6 ("Region of Durham – Unflood Ontario: Call to Action Resolution") of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item 6.20

Council Members discussed the motion and supporting the development of a suicide and crisis prevention hotline.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Item 6.20 ("Town of Caledon – Support for 988 a 3-digit Suicide and Crisis Prevention Hotline") of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item 6.22

Council Members asked questions regarding alternatives available to the Town and timelines. Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

That Item 6.22 ("Doug Montgomery, Ajax resident – Loss of ACC Skatepark & Basketball Courts") of the Correspondence Report be received for information.

CARRIED

## 7. Reports

### 7.1 Community Affairs & Planning Report

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the Community Affairs & Planning Report dated April 6, 2021, be adopted.

CARRIED

### 7.2 General Government Committee Report

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the General Government Committee Report dated April 12, 2021, be adopted.

CARRIED

### 7.3 Summary of Advisory Committee Activities

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the Summary of Advisory Committee Activities Report dated April 19, 2021, as attached to the meeting agenda be received for information, and that the recommendations contained therein be referred to staff where applicable.

CARRIED

### 7.4 Departmental Reports

#### 7.4.1 OES-2021-01: Fuller Road Reconstruction

Council Members asked questions regarding future plans for pedestrian / cycling facilities and share the road signage. D. Meredith responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

1. That Council award the contract for Fuller Road Reconstruction to Mar-King Construction Company Ltd. in the amount of $2,477,085.74 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Staff award the contract for Contract Administration ~ Fuller Road Reconstruction, to The Municipal Infrastructure Group Ltd. in the amount of $185,303.05 (inclusive of all taxes).

CARRIED

7.4.2 **CAO-2021-03: Municipal Fire Protection Grant 2021**

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That Council authorize staff to enter into a formal agreement with the Office of the Fire Marshal and Emergency Management to receive funding of $34,100 towards enhancing the Town's virtual service offerings and training opportunities as a result of COVID-19.

CARRIED

7.4.3 **LIS-2021-03: Contract Award – Uniform Security Guard Services – Supplemental Information Report**

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the report entitled "Contract Award – Uniform Security Guard Services – Supplemental Information Report" be received for information.

CARRIED

7.4.4 **FIN-2021-05: Contract Award – Uniformed Security Guard Services**

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

1. That Council award the contract for Uniformed Security Guard Services, to Paragon Protection Ltd. in the estimated amount of $357,811.01 (inclusive of all taxes), for a period of one year.

2. That Council authorize Staff to renew the contract for an additional two, one year periods, pending an analysis and satisfactory performance review at the anniversary date of the contract, in the estimated amount of $737,233.80 (inclusive of all taxes).

CARRIED

## 8. Regional Councillors' Report

Mayor Collier noted that Durham Region Transit is now offering residents free transportation to any vaccination clinic in the Region of Durham. Mayor Collier noted that new reduced fare student passes will be available through Durham Region Transit in September, 2021.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of April 19, 2021 be received for information.

CARRIED

## 9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.1 **Stop Asian Hate**

Councillor Bower and Regional Councillor Lee introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: S. Lee

**WHEREAS** widespread reports, surveys and personal experiences from across the Asian community have indicated a disturbing increase in anti-Asian racism, discrimination, infringements on basic human rights and acts of violence in Canada and around the world – impacting Asians of all nationalities including a Filipino-American woman beaten in NYC,

the six Asian-Americans of Chinese and Korean descent murdered in the Atlanta spa shootings, and many more – sparking protests across Canada and the United States in March 2021;

**AND WHEREAS** the Chinese Canadian National Council Toronto chapter compiled feedback from the Asian community through two online (self-reporting) surveys, that together reported over 1,150 instances of anti-Asian racism between March 10, 2020 and February 28, 2021 (with approximately half of those incidents reported since January, and nearly 40% having occurred in Ontario), which is believed to have been exacerbated and aggravated due to widespread scapegoating, and racialization of the Covid-19 pandemic;

**AND WHEREAS** according to an Angus Reid study (2020), 43% of surveyed Canadians of Asian-descent report feeling threatened or intimidated as a direct result of Covid-19;

**AND WHEREAS** racism in Canada is an ugly part of our ongoing history, and we must as a community stand together to condemn these acts and commit to taking positive action to correct misinformation and ensure the safety of our neighbours, friends and families;

**NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:**

1. Ajax Council formally stands beside Ajacians of Asian descent, and with all Asian community members across Canada to condemn and denounce these deplorable, racist and hateful acts and encourages victims and bystanders to report these incidents;

2. Ajax Council supports the Chinese Canadian National Council's calls for immediate action, and urges the Province of Ontario and Government of Canada to lead and support meaningful education, engagement and anti-racism efforts, fostering understanding and correcting misinformation for all targeted underrepresented groups in Canada, including the Asian community; and

3. This motion be distributed to Rt. Hon. Justin Trudeau, Prime Minister of Canada; Hon. Bardish Chagger, Minister of Diversity and Inclusion and Youth; Hon. Mark Holland, MP for Ajax; Hon. Doug Ford, Premier of Ontario; Hon. Todd Smith, Minister of Children, Community and Social Services; Rod Phillips, MPP for Ajax; John Henry, Regional Chair; all Durham municipal Councils; and the Chinese Canadian National Council Toronto chapter.

CARRIED

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Regional Councillor Lee, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Khan, Councillor Tyler Morin, Councillor Bower, Mayor Collier

Opposed: None

9.2 **Removing 412/418 Tolls**

Councillor Tyler Morin and Councillor Khan introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: A. Khan

**WHEREAS** Highways 412 and 418 in Durham Region are the only north-south connector roads tolled between Highways 407 and 401, but function in much the same way as non-tolled connector roads in the west end of Toronto and the Greater Toronto and Hamilton Area like Highways 403, 410 and 427;

**AND WHEREAS** these north-south connections are critical to the timely flow of goods and people across the GTHA, but the current tolling system only in Durham Region creates inequality between east and west GTHA residents and their ability to access alternative express routes, and forces many onto local and regional roads like Lakeridge Road between Ajax and Whitby, which are not designed to handle current levels of traffic;

**AND WHEREAS** removing the tolls was a top election issue in 2018, but no final decisions have been made or action taken to move forward in a timely way with MPP French's Bill 43, *The Freeing Highways 412 and 418 Act* (first introduced in the Legislature in October 2018 and referred to the Standing Committee on Finance and Economic Affairs in

November 2020) to remove tolls on these roads;

**NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:**

1. Ajax Council acknowledges and thanks the Province of Ontario for freezing current toll rates as the tolling decision is reconsidered and requests that this freeze continue until a final decision is made;

2. Ajax Council urges the Minister of Transportation to immediately remove the tolls on Highways 412 and 418 to ensure equal access to north-south express connections in Durham Region;

3. Ajax Council thanks MPP French for her ongoing advocacy on this matter; and

4. This motion be distributed to Hon. Caroline Mulroney, Minister of Transportation; MPP Rod Phillips; MPP Jennifer French; Regional Chair John Henry; and all Durham Region municipalities.

CARRIED

9.3 **Corporate Greenhouse Gas Emissions**

Regional Councillor Lee and Regional Councillor Dies introduced the motion and reviewed its contents. G. Romanowski and C. Richardson responded to questions on the motion from Council Members. C. Richardson noted that staff are currently developing green development and environmental design guidelines for the Town.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: J. Dies

**WHEREAS** the Town of Ajax continues to demonstrate leadership in environmental policy and accompanying actions, including ongoing involvement with the network of Partners for Climate Protection (PCP) led by the Federation of Canadian Municipalities (FCM) as part of ICLEI's Cities for Climate Protection (CCP) network (a network of 1,100 communities worldwide), and as a member, Ajax completed the Integrated Community Sustainability Plan, 2013 and committed to take action against climate change by completing a five milestone framework for reducing greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions, and achieved Milestone 5 for both community and corporate categories in September 2017 (three years early);

**AND WHEREAS** in June 2019, Council endorsed the Ajax Climate Risk and Resiliency Plan to provide a strategic planning framework (outlining 8 objectives) taking a holistic approach to adapt and address the risks and vulnerabilities associated with climate change, and complement works done to achieve Milestone 5;

**AND WHEREAS** Ajax Council joined approximately 800 governments worldwide in declaring a Climate Emergency in 2019, but to date the Town's GHG emissions targets have not been updated since achieving Milestone 5 objectives, and since then the Region of Durham has completed their Community Energy Plan, outlining a region-wide goal of reducing GHG emissions 10% below 2019 levels by 2025, 30% below 2019 levels by 2030, and 100% below 2019 levels by 2050;

**AND WHEREAS** an alarming study (March 2021) by The Atmospheric Fund (TAF) found that emissions *increased* by 7% in Toronto and 5.2% across the Greater Toronto and Hamilton Area (GTHA) from 2017 to 2018, and that 44% of Ontario's total carbon emissions are from the GTHA;

**AND WHEREAS** many municipalities are moving toward establishing a separate climate change reserve fund to dedicate resources in case of natural disaster or to leverage funding opportunities from upper levels of government;

**NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:**

1. Ajax Council reaffirm its commitment to the environment by proactively mitigating and adapting to climate change impacts;

2. Ajax Council establish the following corporate GHG emission reduction targets, and that these targets be reflected in an upcoming Corporate Climate Change Action Plan update:

    - 20% GHG emissions reduction by 2025, below 2019 levels;
    - 40% GHG emissions reduction by 2030, below 2019 levels;

- 100% GHG emissions reduction by 2050, below 2019 levels;

3. Ajax Council endorse the Region of Durham's community GHG emission reduction targets:

   - 10% GHG emissions reduction by 2025, below 2019 levels;
   - 30% GHG emissions reduction by 2030, below 2019 levels;
   - 100% GHG emissions reduction by 2050, below 2019 levels; and

4. Staff be directed to examine the feasibility of creating a Climate Reserve Fund, including investigating and assessing how funds for the reserve could be identified and allocated, and to report back to the appropriate standing committee of Council with recommendations.

CARRIED

9.4 **Naming of a New Parkette for an Ajax Resident**

**Authority to Hold a Closed Meeting and Related In-Camera Session (9:33 p.m.)**

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Council convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Section 239 (2) (b) of the *Municipal Act, 2001,* as amended, to discuss personal matters about an identifiable individual, including municipal or local board employees.

CARRIED

**Open Meeting (9:39 p.m.)**

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Regional Councillor Crawford assumed the Chair.

Mayor Collier and Councillor Bower introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: L. Bower

**WHEREAS** The Town of Ajax celebrates its history through street and public space naming practices, which identify and highlight legacies important to understanding the foundations of Ajax as a municipality;

**AND WHEREAS** Ajax Council has a vision of intentional, environment-conscious design for new or redesigned public spaces;

**NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:**

Staff be directed to create a small parkette in the naturalized area at Harwood Avenue and the 401 that will be:

- Named after the individual discussed in the closed session of Council held on April 19th, 2021;

- Fitted with a sign, benches and plantings, featuring pollinator-attractive flora; and

- Unveiled at a socially-distanced and COVID-aware dedication event, if provincially permitted at the time.

CARRIED

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

## 10. By-laws

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: A. Khan

That By-law numbers 20-2021 to 28-2021 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

## 11. Notice of Motion

There were no notices of motion.

## 12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members noted that Durham Region residents over the age of 40 are now eligible to receive the AstraZeneca vaccine. Members of Council highlighted upcoming events and activities including a mobile vaccination clinic at Bolton C. Falby Public School on April 21, 2021, Earth Day on April 22, 2021, Lakeridge Health Telephone Town Hall on April 22, 2021, and a community Ward 3 meeting on April 26, 2021.

## 13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law number 29-2021 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its meeting held on April 19, 2021 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

## 14. Adjournment

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: A. Khan

That the April 19, 2021 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (9:48 p.m.)

CARRIED

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Mayor

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D-Clerk